THE
CONNECTION
PROJECT

CONNECTION DOESN'T END HERE.

Between Us is part of The Connection Project, a design-led initiative exploring how we understand ourselves, navigate relationships and build meaningful connections with others.

Through reflection, visual storytelling and interactive experiences, the project invites us to question familiar patterns and explore new perspectives on connection.

Connection isn't something we have to figure out all at once. It's something we continue to learn.

EXPLORE. REFLECT. CONNECT.

THE
CONNECTION
PROJECT

BETWEEN US.

A journal for noticing the patterns we carry into connection.

A MORE INTENTIONAL YOU

Between us is a guided reflective journal designed to help you notice, understand and explore the patterns you carry into connection.

Our relationships with friends, partners, family and even ourselves shape the way we think, feel and respond to the world around us.

This journal creates space to slow down, reflect on your experiences and develop a deeper understanding of yourself and the way you connect with others.

HOW TO USE THIS JOURNAL.

01

TAKE YOUR TIME

Move through the activities at your own pace. There is no set order or time limit.

02

BE HONEST

This space is for you. Explore your thoughts and feelings openly, without judgement.

03

REFLECT

Use the prompts to explore your experiences, recognise patterns and discover new perspectives.

04

MAKE IT YOURS

There are no right or wrong answers. Write, draw or skip anything that doesn't feel right for you.

ACTIVITY 01

RECOGNISE

WHAT FEELS FAMILIAR?

When connection feels uncertain, we all respond in different ways. Some patterns are easy to notice, while others can be more subtle.

This activity invites you to explore the responses that feel familiar to you and consider what might be happening underneath.

01 I go quiet or withdraw when I feel overwhelmed.

02 I take on other people's emotions.

03 I look for reassurance when I feel uncertain.

04 I try to keep the peace, even when something bothers me.

05 I need space to process my thoughts and feelings.

Take what resonates, leave what doesn't. There's no right or wrong way to reflect.

YOUR PATTERNS

MAP YOUR RESPONSES

Place the responses from the previous page along the line based on how familiar they feel to you.
You can write the statements, use their numbers or add responses of your own.



WHAT DO YOU NOTICE?

Which responses feel most familiar to you?

When do these responses usually appear?

What might be influencing these patterns?

ACTIVITY 02

MAP THE MOMENT.

WHAT WAS HAPPENING BENEATH MY REACTION?

When something in a relationship feels difficult, uncertain or meaningful, there are often many things happening at once, our thoughts, feelings, needs and the way we respond.

This activity invites you to slow down and explore a specific moment to better understand what might have been happening beneath the surface.

HOW IT WORKS

01 Think of a moment when a connection felt different, challenging or meaningful.

02 Use the map on the opposite page to explore what happened, what you felt and how you responded.

03 Take a moment to consider what this experience might reveal about yourself.

YOUR MAP

Think about a specific interaction or experience. Use the prompts to explore what happened, how you felt and what you might have needed.

01 MOMENT

What happened?

02 THOUGHTS

What was going through my mind?

ME

03 FEELING

What emotions did I notice?

04 RESPONSE

How did I react?

05 NEED

What might I have needed in that moment?

ACTIVITY 03

LOOKING CLOSER

WHAT MIGHT THIS TELL ME?

Now that you've explored a specific moment, take a step back and look a little deeper. Sometimes our reactions are influenced by feelings, expectations or experiences we don't immediately recognise.

This activity invites you to explore what was happening before, during and after the moment, and what it might reveal about yourself.

01 BEFORE

What was I bringing into this moment?

02 DURING

What felt most important to me?

03 AFTER

How do I see this moment now?

GOING FURTHER

01 WHAT PATTERNS DO YOU NOTICE?

Are there any familiar thoughts, feelings or behaviours that tend to show up in moments like this?

02 WHAT MIGHT I HAVE NEEDED?

What would have helped me feel more supported, understood or comfortable in that moment?

03 WHAT COULD I DO DIFFERENTLY?

Is there another way I could respond, communicate or take care of myself next time?

04 A KINDER PERSPECTIVE

What would I say to a friend experiencing something similar? How could I offer myself that same understanding?

ACTIVITY 04

DRAW THE DISTANCE

HOW DOES CONNECTION FEEL AROUND YOU?

Not every relationship feels the same. Some people make us feel close, understood and supported, while others may feel more distant or uncertain.

HOW IT WORKS

01 Think of 3-5 relationships in your life.

02 Place each person around the central “ME” circle based on how emotionally close or distant they feel.

03 Use initials, symbols or labels and draw lines to show how each connection feels.

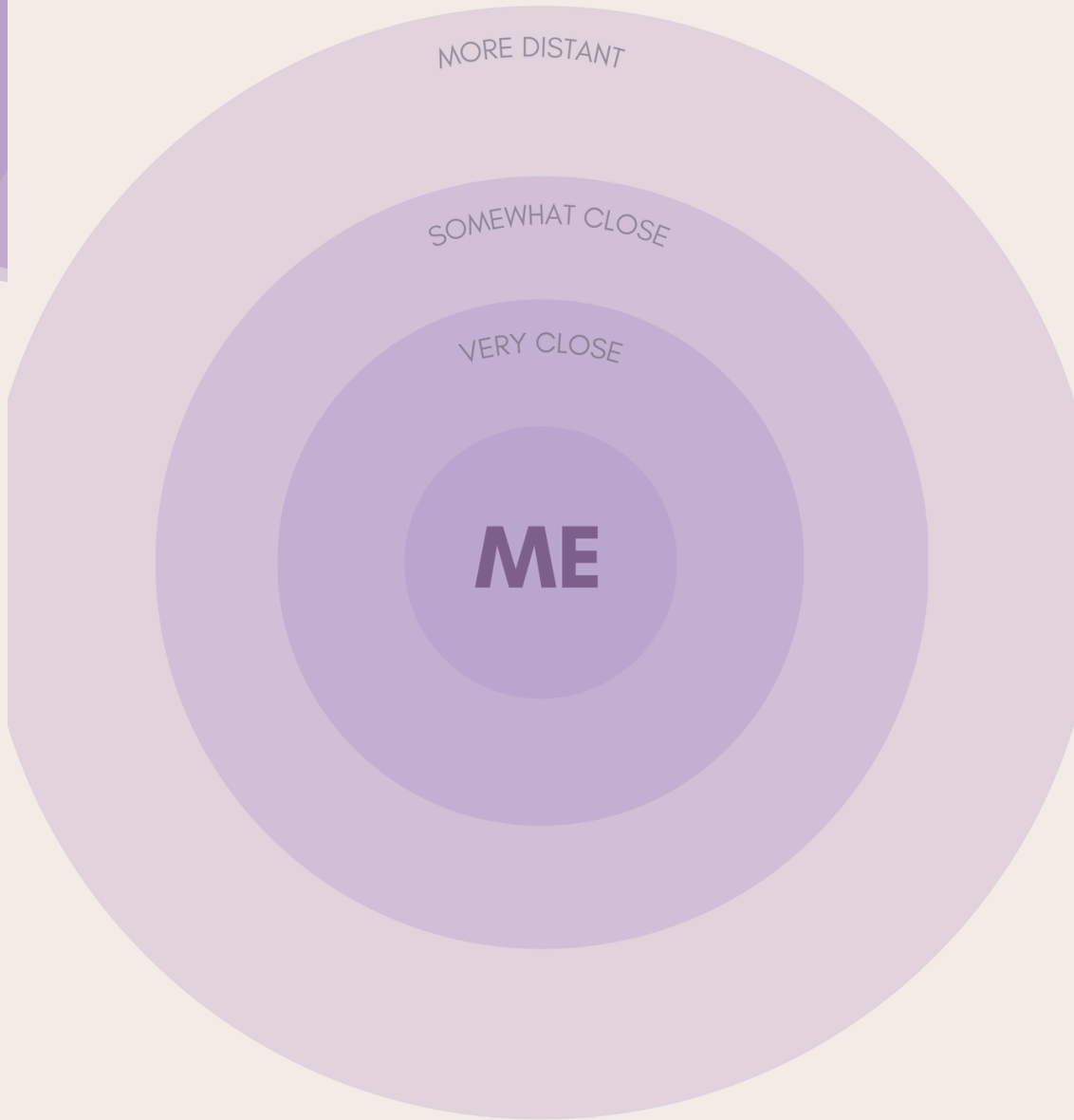
CONNECTION KEY

——————— Connected

– – – – – – – – – – – – – – – Uncertain

..... Shifting

YOUR MAP



ACTIVITY 05

BEYOND THE DISTANCE

WHAT DO MY CONNECTIONS MEAN TO ME?

Look back at the connections you've mapped. What stands out to you? This page invites you to reflect on what your map might be telling you about your relationships, your needs and what feels important to you.

01 **Which connections feel most meaningful to me?**

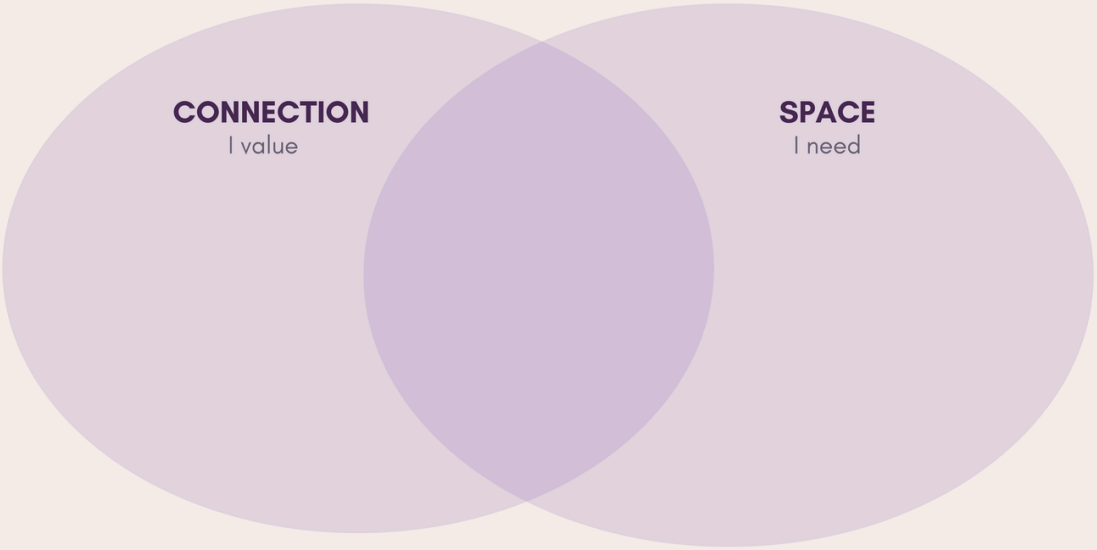
02 **Are there relationships where I need more space or clearer boundaries?**

03 **What have I noticed about my own needs from this map?**

CLOSENESS & SPACE

TWO THINGS CAN BE TRUE AT ONCE.

You can value a connection and still need space.
You can care for someone and also have boundaries.
Both can exist at the same time.



HOW CAN I HONOUR BOTH?

What could I do to nurture a connection while also respecting my own need for space or a boundary?

ACTIVITY 06

READ BETWEEN THE LINES

WHAT AM I REALLY TRYING TO COMMUNICATE?

What we show on the outside isn't always what we feel on the inside. Our words, actions and reactions can sometimes hide what's really happening underneath.

This activity invites you to slow down and look a little deeper, to notice what might be going on beneath the surface.



As you reflect, try to be curious rather than critical. What might be going on beneath the surface of what you showed?

YOUR REFLECTION

Think about a time when you felt misunderstood or when a conversation didn't go as you hoped. Use the space below to explore what was going on.

WHAT I SHOWED

What might another person have seen, heard or noticed from me?

WHAT I REALLY FELT

What might have been happening underneath?

WHAT MIGHT MY RESPONSE HAVE BEEN PROTECTING?

WHAT DID I ACTUALLY NEED IN THAT MOMENT?

ACTIVITY 07

UNDERSTAND AND CHOOSE

WHAT MIGHT I NEED MOVING FORWARD?

Understanding our patterns is one step. Recognising our needs and considering how we respond can help us build more intentional connections.

NOTICE



What am I feeling?

UNDERSTAND



What might I need?

CHOOSE



How could I respond?

A GENTLE REMINDER

Small choices can create meaningful changes in the way we connect. Progress doesn't have to happen all at once.

YOUR EXPLORATION

WHAT DO I NEED?

Choose one or two needs that feel most important to you right now.
You can tick more than one.

- ○ Reassurance
- ○ Clear communication
- ○ Space
- ○ Quality time
- ○ Honesty
- ○ Understanding
- ○ Consistency
- ○

HOW COULD I COMMUNICATE THIS NEED?

What could I say to help someone understand what I need?

I've been feeling _____, and it would help me if _____

ONE SMALL CHANGE

What's one response or approach I could try differently next time?
It could be something small, but meaningful.

FINAL REFLECTION

CONNECTING THE DOTS

WHAT HAVE I LEARNED ABOUT MYSELF?

Now that you've explored different aspects of your relationships, take a moment to look back at what you've discovered.

This final activity invites you to bring together your reflections and consider what you want to carry forward.



EXPLORE
Different perspectives and experiences.



UNDERSTAND
Your patterns, needs and boundaries.



MOVE FORWARD
With more intention and self-awareness.

YOUR REFLECTION

Use the prompts below to reflect on what you've noticed throughout this journal. There are no right or wrong answers, this is your space to pause and consider what you want to carry forward.

A PATTERN I'VE NOTICED...

SOMETHING I'M BEGINNING TO UNDERSTAND...

SOMETHING I WANT TO CARRY FORWARD...